

Arthritis Support Groups in Scotland

Practical NHS-backed advice on arthritis support groups near me scotland.

By **Living With Arthritis UK** · Reviewed by **Louis Maxwell** (HCPC Registered Physiotherapist) · 2026-07-24 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

Arthritis Support Groups in Scotland

Quick Answer: Arthritis support groups across Scotland are run by Versus Arthritis, NHS Boards, and community organisations. To find one near you, call the Versus Arthritis helpline (0800 5200 520), search versusarthritis.org, or ask your GP or rheumatology nurse for local referrals.

Peer support from others who understand life with arthritis provides practical advice and emotional benefit that clinical appointments alone cannot offer. Scotland has a well-developed network of support groups, both in-person and online.

Versus Arthritis Groups in Scotland

Versus Arthritis supports self-help groups across Scotland, particularly in Glasgow, Edinburgh, Aberdeen, Dundee, and Inverness. Groups are free, run by trained volunteers with lived experience of arthritis, and cover pain management, exercise, and mutual support.

How to Find a Group

- Visit versusarthritis.org/support/self-help-groups
 - Call the helpline: 0800 5200 520 (Mon–Fri 9am–6pm)
 - Ask your rheumatology nurse or GP for local group details
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NHS Self-Management in Scotland



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NHS Boards including NHS Lothian, NHS Greater Glasgow and Clyde, and NHS Grampian run free self-management programmes for arthritis — typically 6–8 week courses. Ask your GP for a referral or search your NHS Board website.

Online Groups Accessible from Scotland

Versus Arthritis's online community (community.versusarthritis.org) and the NRAS community on Healthunlocked are particularly active and welcoming, accessible from anywhere in Scotland.

Q&A;



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Question: Are arthritis support groups in Scotland free to attend? **Short answer:** Yes — groups run by Versus Arthritis and NHS Boards are free. Some community groups may ask for a small voluntary contribution to cover room hire.

Question: I'm in rural Scotland — can I still access support? **Short answer:** Yes — online groups and the Versus Arthritis helpline are accessible from anywhere in Scotland. Some groups also meet by video call.

Question: Can I join a group without a formal diagnosis? **Short answer:** Yes — you're welcome to attend most support groups while awaiting diagnosis or with suspected arthritis.